A HANDS-ON WORKSHOP

Beyond AI Slop

Building better interfaces with design systems

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START HERE

Join the studio. Pair up if needed.

`juneadkhan.github.io/hacknc-beyond-ai-slop/`

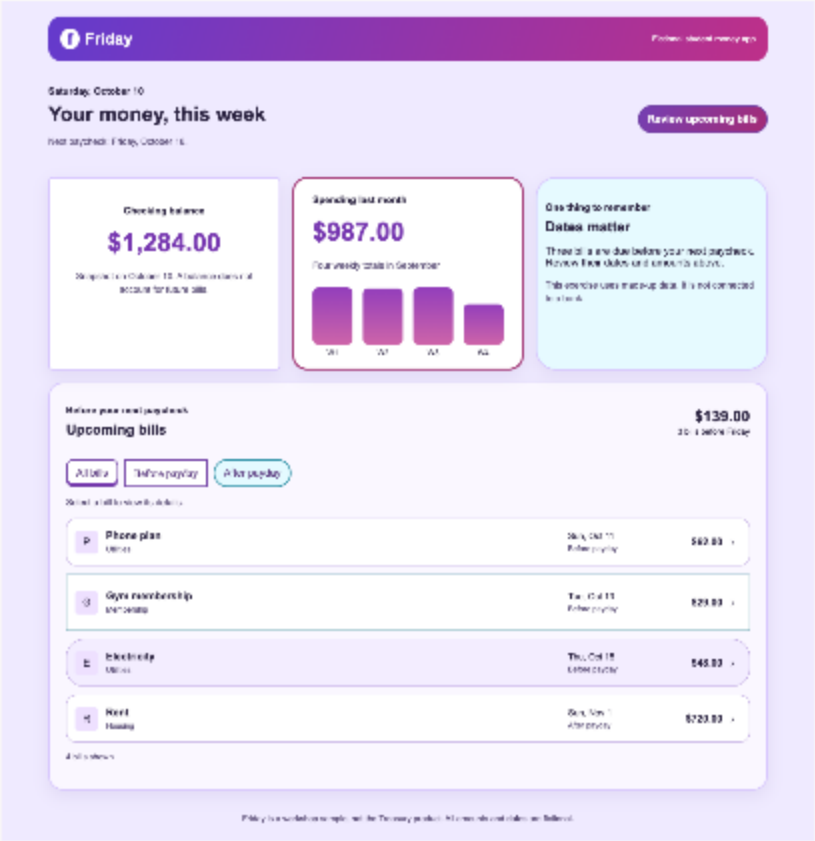


No setup for the studio

Browser + your AI chat. Nothing to install.

No AI access? Use a reference
and change its tokens.

First, try the user's task.



Which bills are due before Friday?

Find the dates and amounts.

Same task for every style.

Name the failure you can observe.

Hierarchy

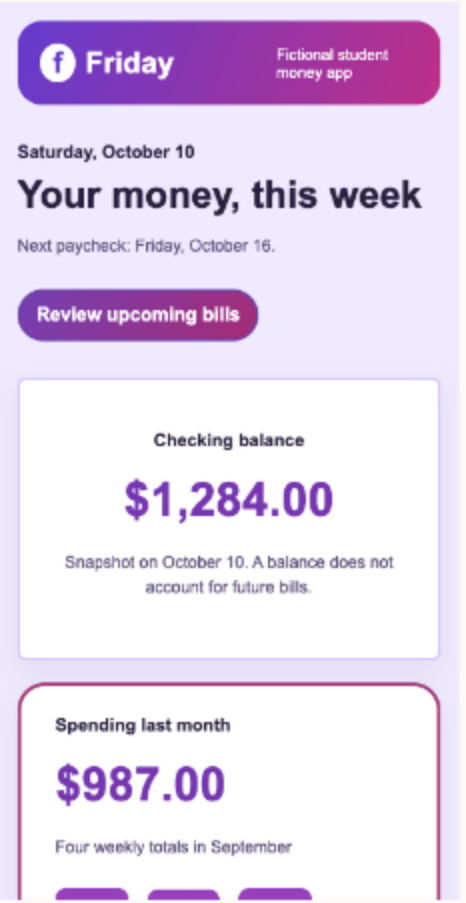
The secondary metrics get attention before bill dates.

Component rules

Three filters look like three unrelated controls.

Small screens

The important list moves below secondary content.



Give AI decisions it can reuse.

01

Purpose

Find bills before payday.

02

Tokens

Name roles, then assign values.

03

Components

Reuse rows, filters and panels.

04

Rules

Define priority, states and mobile.

A shared system still leaves room for your own taste.

Name the role. Reuse the value.

```
:root {
  --surface: #ffffff;
  --text: #1c303c;
  --accent: #214e63;
  --on-accent: #ffffff;
  --space-4: 16px;
}
```

```
.button-primary {
  background: var(--accent);
  color: var(--on-accent);
  padding: var(--space-4);
}
```

One shared decision can update several components.

Specify the states and the exceptions.

Bill rows

Same date, amount and spacing rules for every bill.

Buttons and filters

Default, hover, selected and visible keyboard focus.

Responsive hierarchy

Bills remain first; amounts stay beside their own bill.

Start with foundations that fit your project.

Carbon

IBM’s product system

Foundations, components and usage guidance.

Fluent 2

Microsoft’s design system

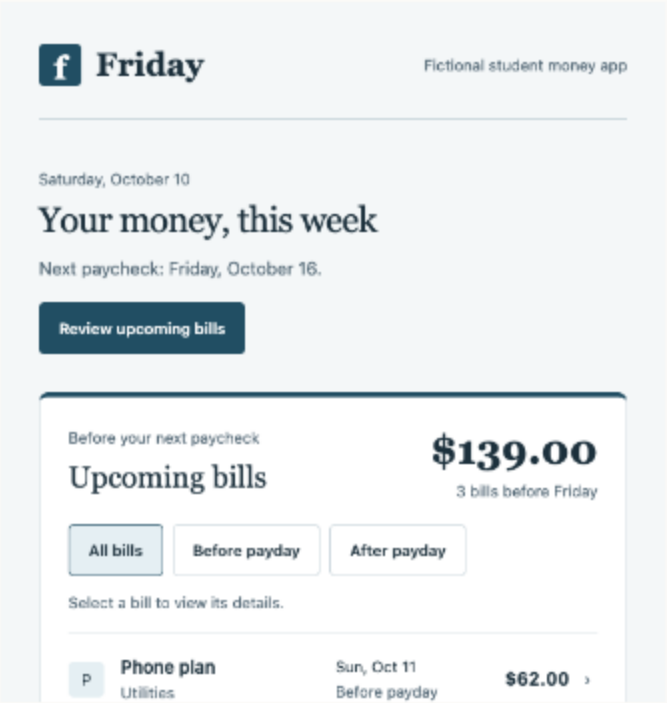
Resources and components for several platforms.

Radix Primitives

Unstyled behaviors

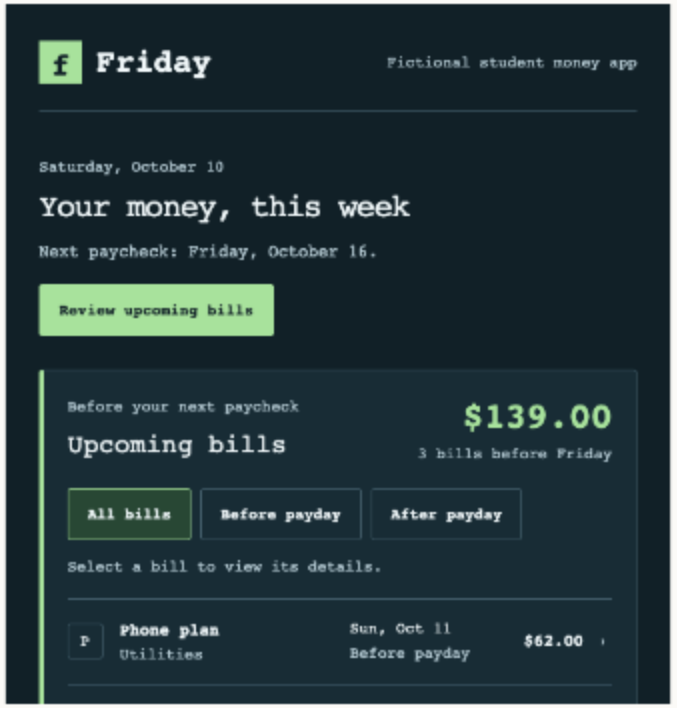
Accessible building blocks; you supply visual rules.

Different personalities. Shared discipline.



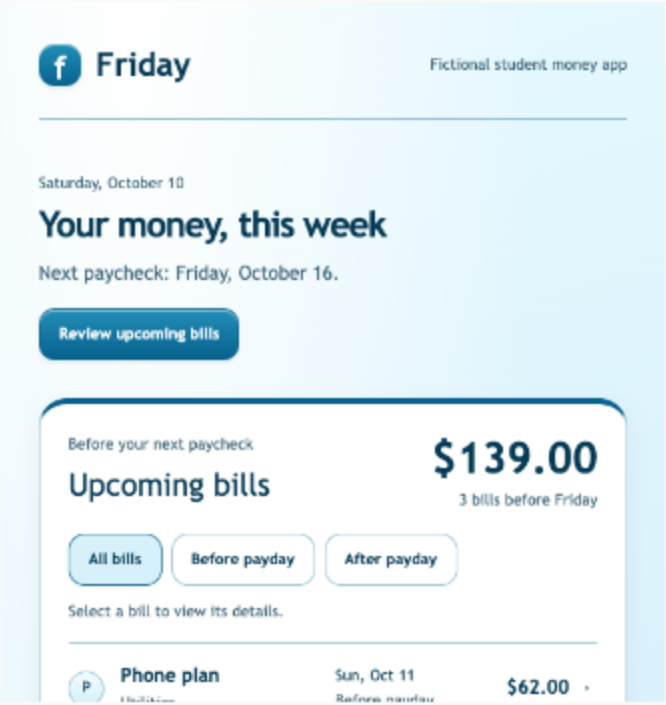
Ledger

Quiet reading



Signal

Technical clarity



Aero

Optimistic gloss

Guide first. Implementation second.

1 Create and review the guide

Purpose, tokens, component rules, states and mobile.

2 Apply one complete stylesheet

Use the fixed DOM and facts. Inspect the rendered app.

3 Revise a specific observed failure

“At 390px, the date wraps away from its amount.”

Your style. The same working app.

Choose a point of view

Audience + mood + typography + density + priority.

Generate → review → apply

A design guide, then a complete CSS stylesheet.

Check mobile and keyboard

Keep every amount, date, filter and detail dialog.

12

minutes

No AI access?
Use a reference
and change tokens.

Swap laptops. Let the screen explain.

Give your partner the task

“Find every bill due before Friday. Open one.”

Look for evidence

Dates and amounts, shared rules, 390px, keyboard.

Share one rule and one remaining issue

What improved? What still gets in the user’s way?

Bring the rules into your own hack.

Write the task and save the guide

Give your coding agent rules it can keep returning to.

Reuse components; change one thing at a time

Inspect the rendered result before moving on.

Make trustworthy information easy to use

A clear date and amount matter more than decoration.

Keep your work. Keep asking why.

Download your app + your design guide

Keep the working interface and the decisions behind it.



Which rule will you use in your hack?

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